

IIT Madras | Strategies for Professional Growth (SPG)

Navigating Growth:

A Study on Workplace
Resilience & Lifelong
Learning



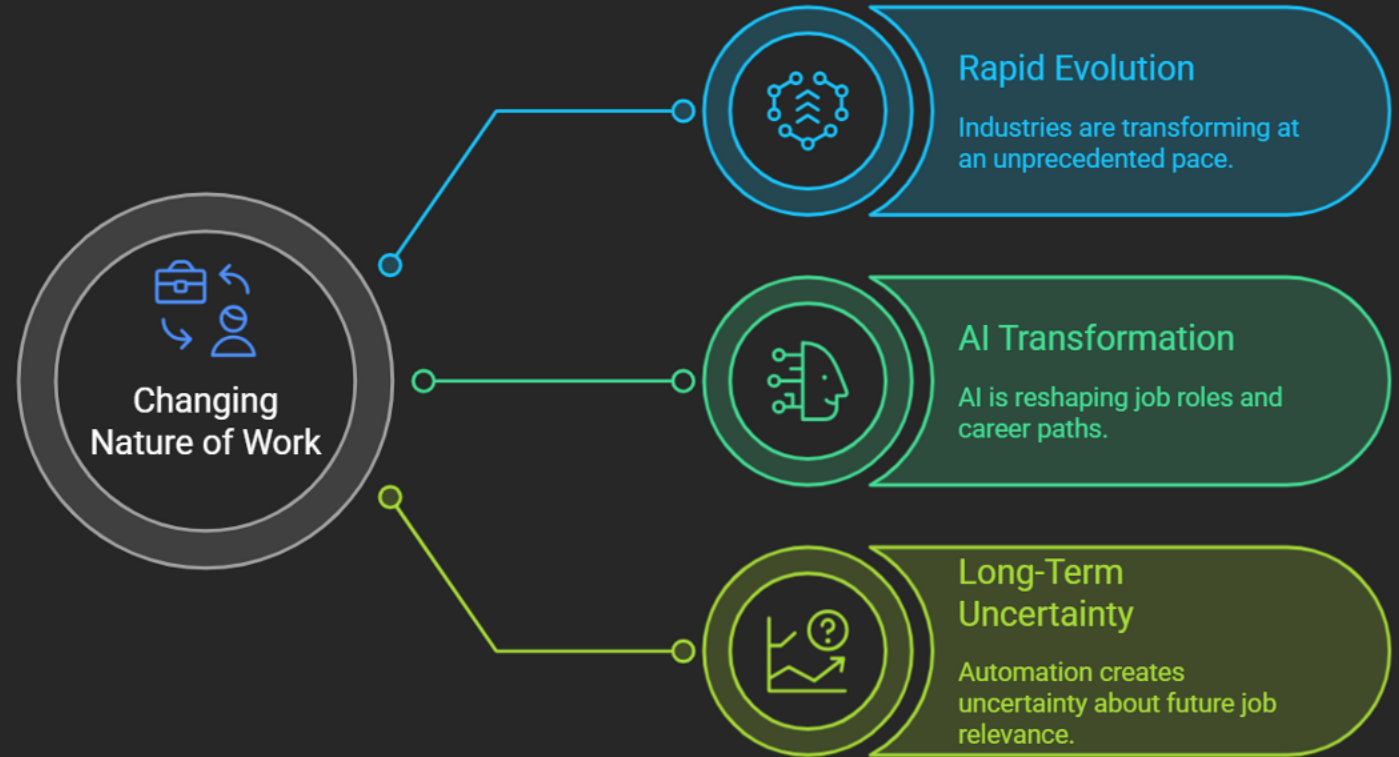
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1 The Big Question in the AI Era



Identifying the human skills that maintain relevance as AI automates routine tasks.



AI Impact

AI is changing how careers work and automating routine tasks.

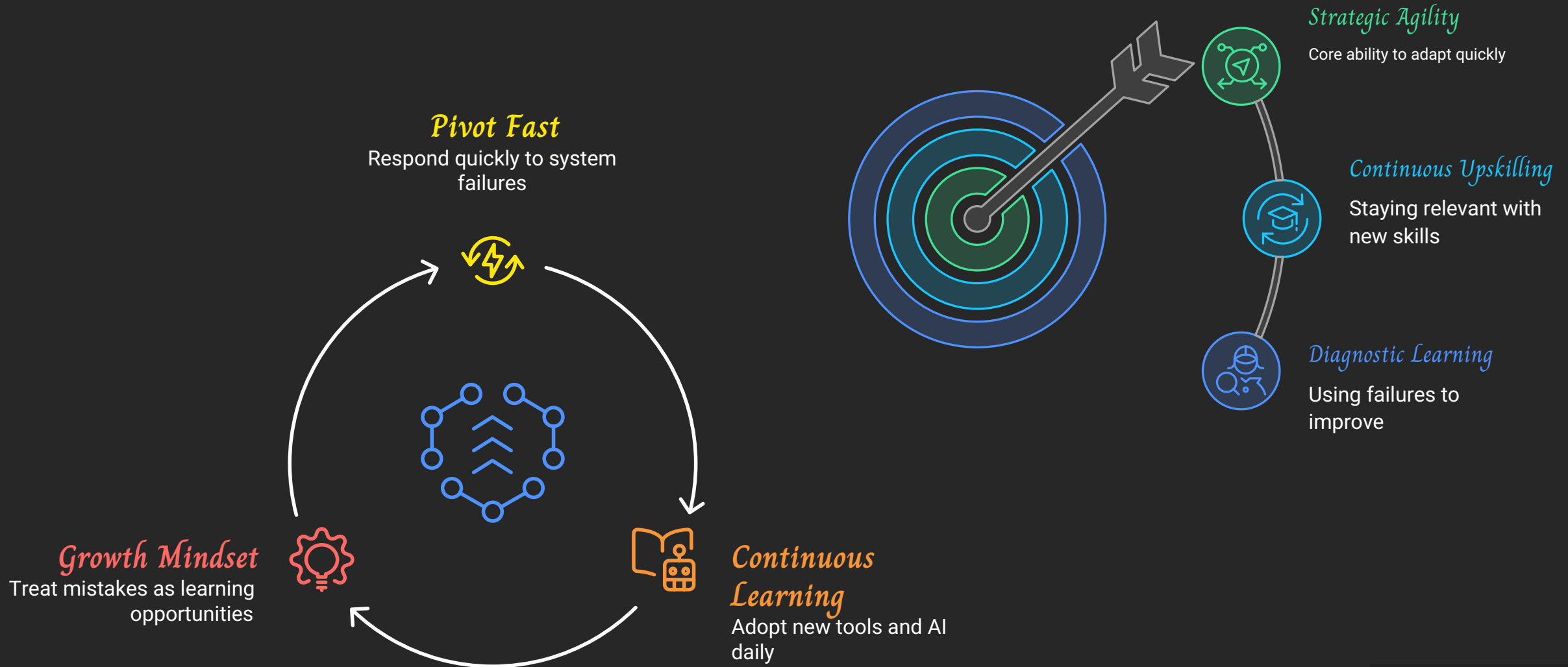
Key Question

What core human capabilities actually help professionals stay resilient and relevant over time?

Industry Scope

Insights from AdTech, MedTech, Construction, Telecom, and AI/ Automation

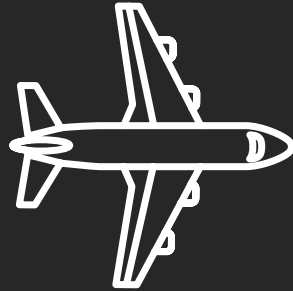
2 Resilience & Learning in High-Stakes Environments



3 MedTech: Learning on the Job



Industry Insights:



Integrated Learning

Learning isn't separate from work; it happens while working.

Hands-on Testing

People learn by solving real problems and testing things out.

Immediate Application

No learn first, apply later, it's learning by doing.

4 Adaptability Beats Fixed Expertise

Focus Area	Core Principle
 Tool Flexibility	Being flexible with new tools matters more than sticking to one skill
 AI as a Catalyst	AI is used to boost output, not seen as a threat
 The Soft Edge	Trust and communication matter as much as technical skill for growth



Traditional Expertise

Rapidly evolving technologies
diminish long-term value

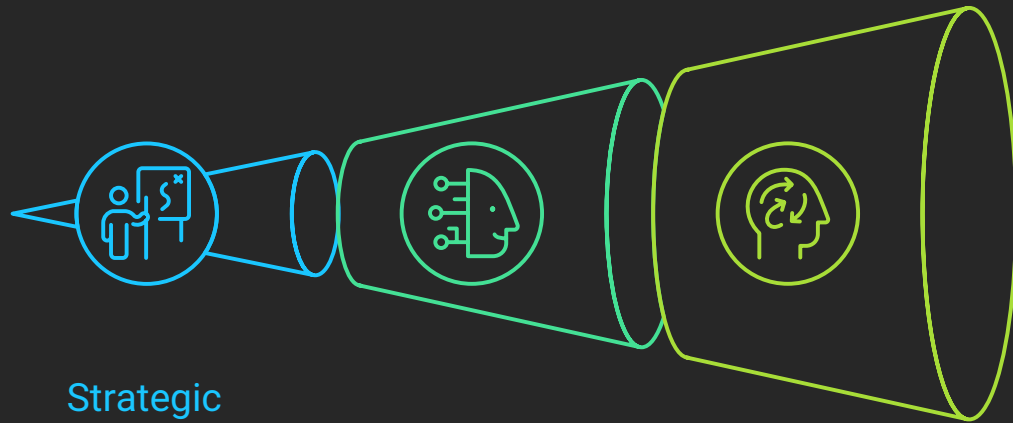


Adaptability & Trust

Essential for career
acceleration

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Construction Industry Insights: AI as a Time-Saver



Strategic Contribution

Professionals contribute to strategic decisions

AI Efficiency

AI reduces time on repetitive tasks

Resilience Development

Challenges are broken down into manageable parts



CONCLUSION

"Resilience is developed by breaking down large challenges into manageable parts"

Strategic Shift

Roles are moving from routine tasks to bigger-picture thinking.

Efficiency Gains

AI cuts task time, leaving room for strategic decisions.

Resilience Strategy

Breaking big problems into small, manageable steps.

6 Survey Results (29 Professionals)

Top 5 skills identified by industry experts for future workplace success.



CONCLUSION

This shows that growth today depends on a combination of learning mindset and technological awareness.

23

Analytical thinking

Analytical thinking identified by industry experts for future workplace success.

17

AI & data literacy

AI & data literacy identified by industry experts for future workplace success.

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Resilience and adaptability

Resilience and adaptability identified by industry experts for future workplace success.

16

Curiosity and continuous learning

Curiosity and continuous learning identified by industry experts for future workplace success.

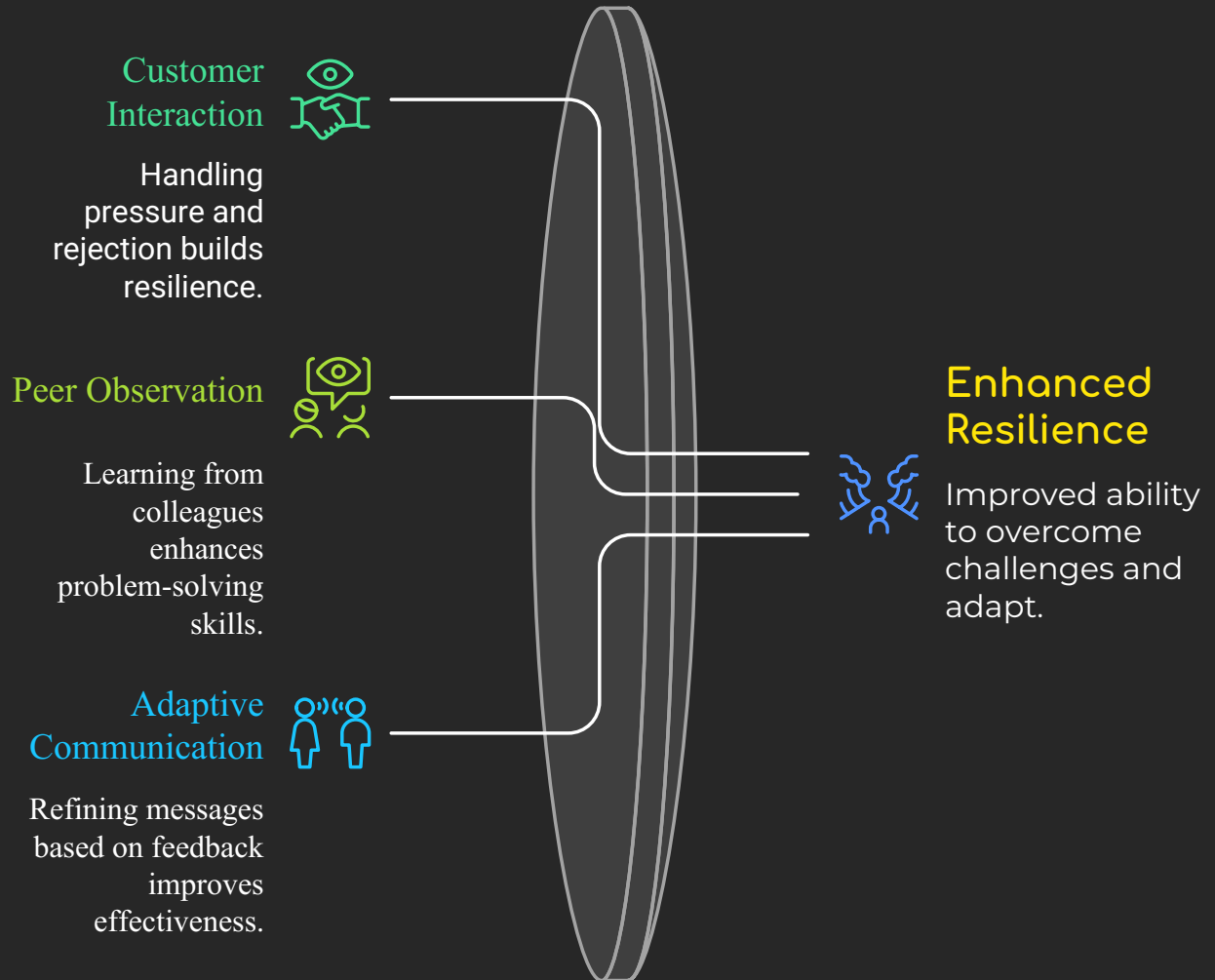
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Creative thinking

Creative thinking identified by industry experts for future workplace success.

7 Telecom: Resilience on the Frontline

Industry Insights:



8

Comparing the strategic value of Automation versus Human Connection



Human Connection

Relationship Growth

Growth is shifting toward relationships, trust, and advice

Building trust with people

The irreplaceable value of human connection, trust, and rapport



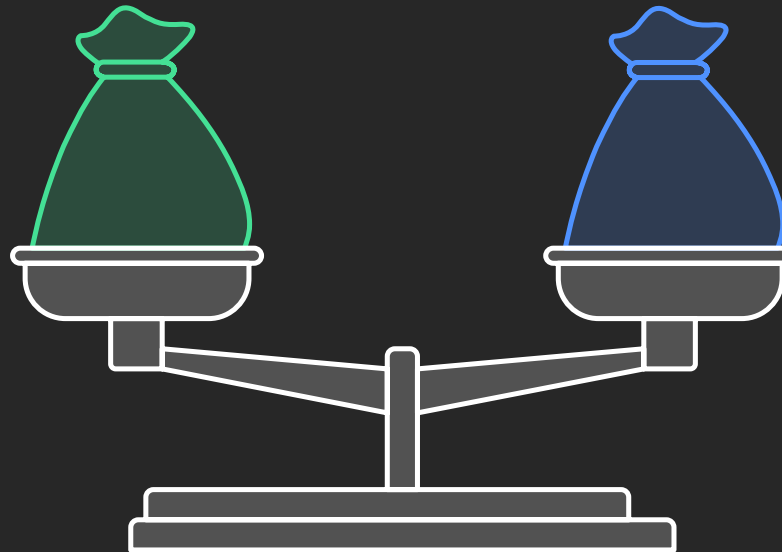
Automation

Task Efficiency

AI is cutting down routine, task-based jobs

Algorithmic Processing

AI cannot replicate real human rapport and connection



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Real Skills Come from Execution

The importance of hands-on experience and the ability to unlearn old habits.

01



Experience First

Courses build a base, but real skill comes from hands-on work.

02



System Agility

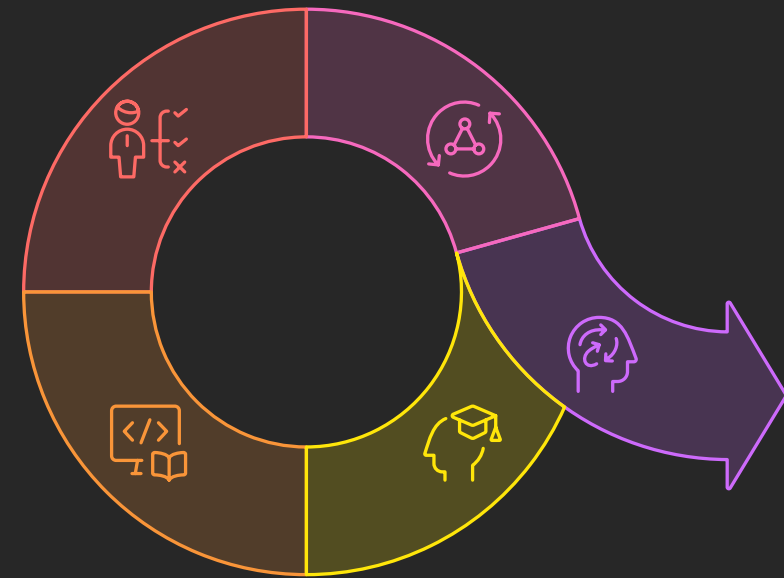
Adapting fast to new systems matters more than rigid processes.

03



Unlearning

Letting go of old habits is just as important as learning new ones.



1

Formal Education

Provides foundational knowledge

2

Build Projects

Apply knowledge in practice

3

Execute Projects

Complete tasks and achieve goals

4

Adapt Systems

Adjust to changing environments

5

Unlearn Practices

Release outdated methods



The Growth Formula

"Technology doesn't replace people, it makes human skills like adaptability and judgment more valuable."

